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Simplr

Accounting schedules, simplified.

User Manual

Phase 0 - Prepaid Expenses Module

Step-by-step guide for setup, data entry,
report generation, and CSV export to Xero / QBO

Version 0.1.0 | March 2026

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1. Opening the App

Open your web browser and go to the Simplr URL provided to you. This can be either the Streamlit Cloud link (e.g., simplr-xxx.streamlit.app) or http://localhost:8501 if running locally on your computer.

You will see the Simplr app with:

- A purple sidebar on the left with the Simplr logo and navigation
- The main content area on the right showing the current page

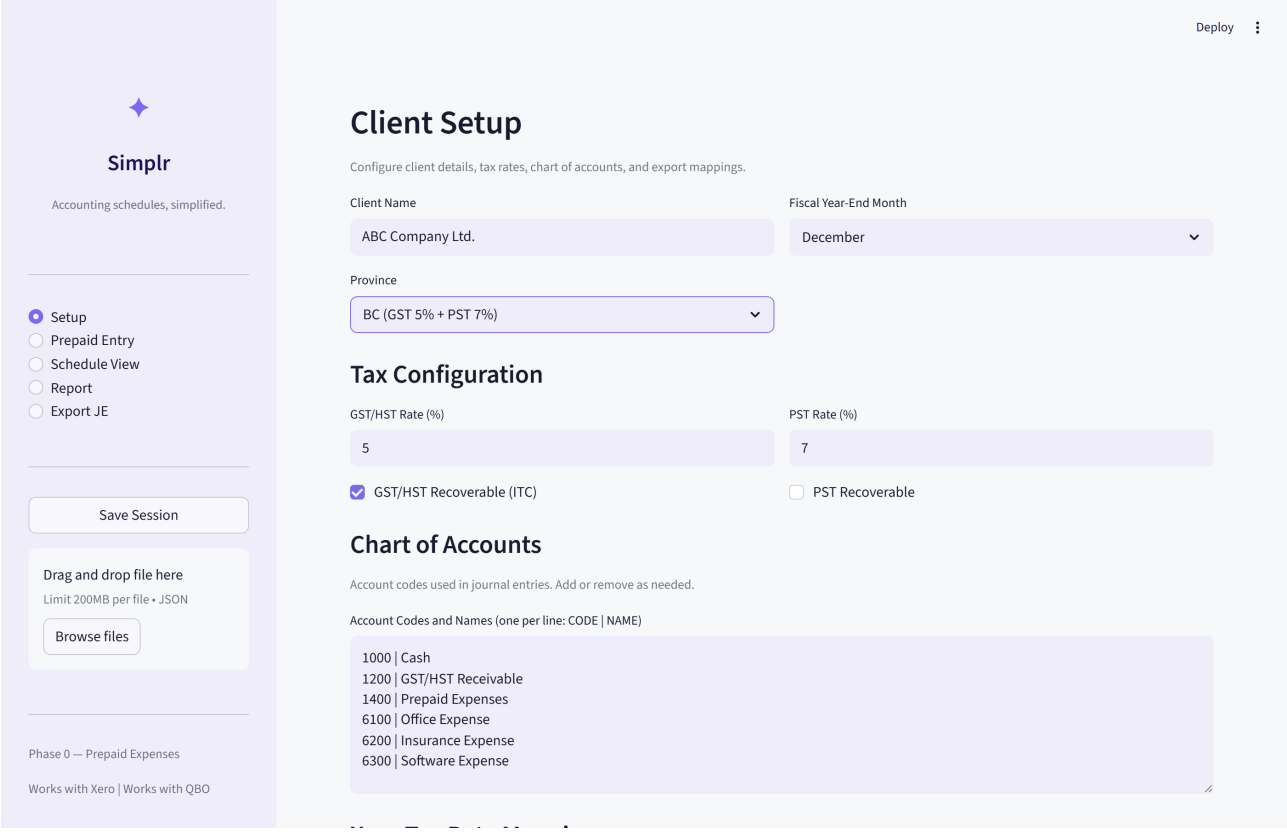


Figure 1.1 - The Setup page is the first thing you see when opening Simplr

2. Understanding the Navigation

The sidebar on the left is your main navigation. Click on any page name to switch to it. The currently selected page shows a filled circle next to it.

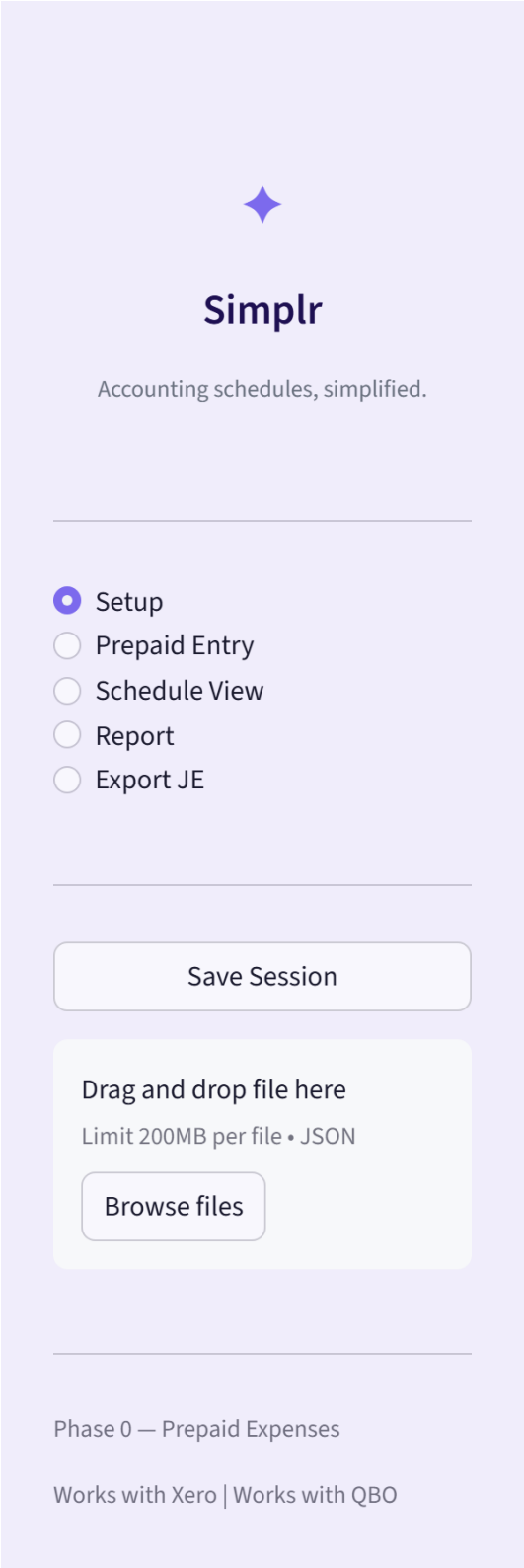


Figure 2.1 - The sidebar with navigation links, Save/Load buttons, and branding

Page	What it does
Setup	Configure client info, tax rates, chart of accounts, Xero mappings
Prepaid Entry	Create new prepaid contracts
Schedule View	View calculated amortization schedules
Report	Generate roll-forward working paper reports
Export JE	Validate and download CSV files for Xero or QBO

Save / Load (bottom of sidebar):

- Save Session button - downloads a JSON file with all your data
- Drag and drop / Browse files area - upload a previously saved JSON to restore your work

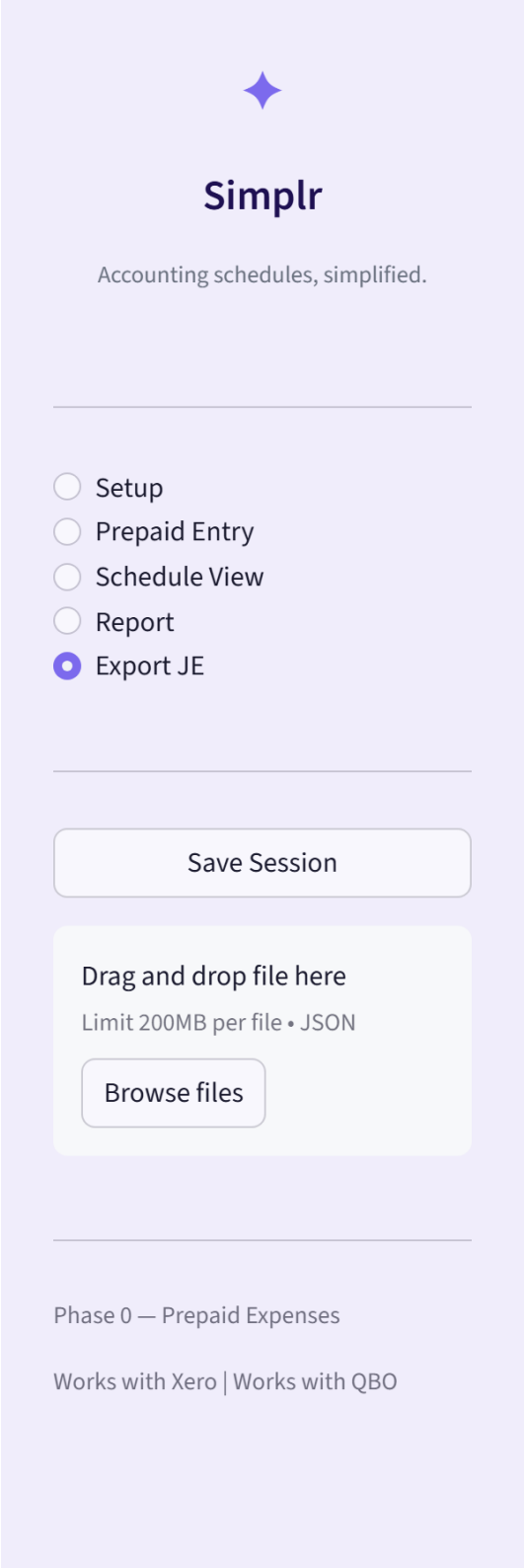


Figure 2.2 - Save Session and Load Session at the bottom of the sidebar

3. Step 1: Client Setup

IMPORTANT: This is the FIRST thing you must do before anything else.

The Setup page configures the client tax rates, chart of accounts, and Xero/QBO mappings.

Click "Setup" in the sidebar to begin. Below is the full Setup page:

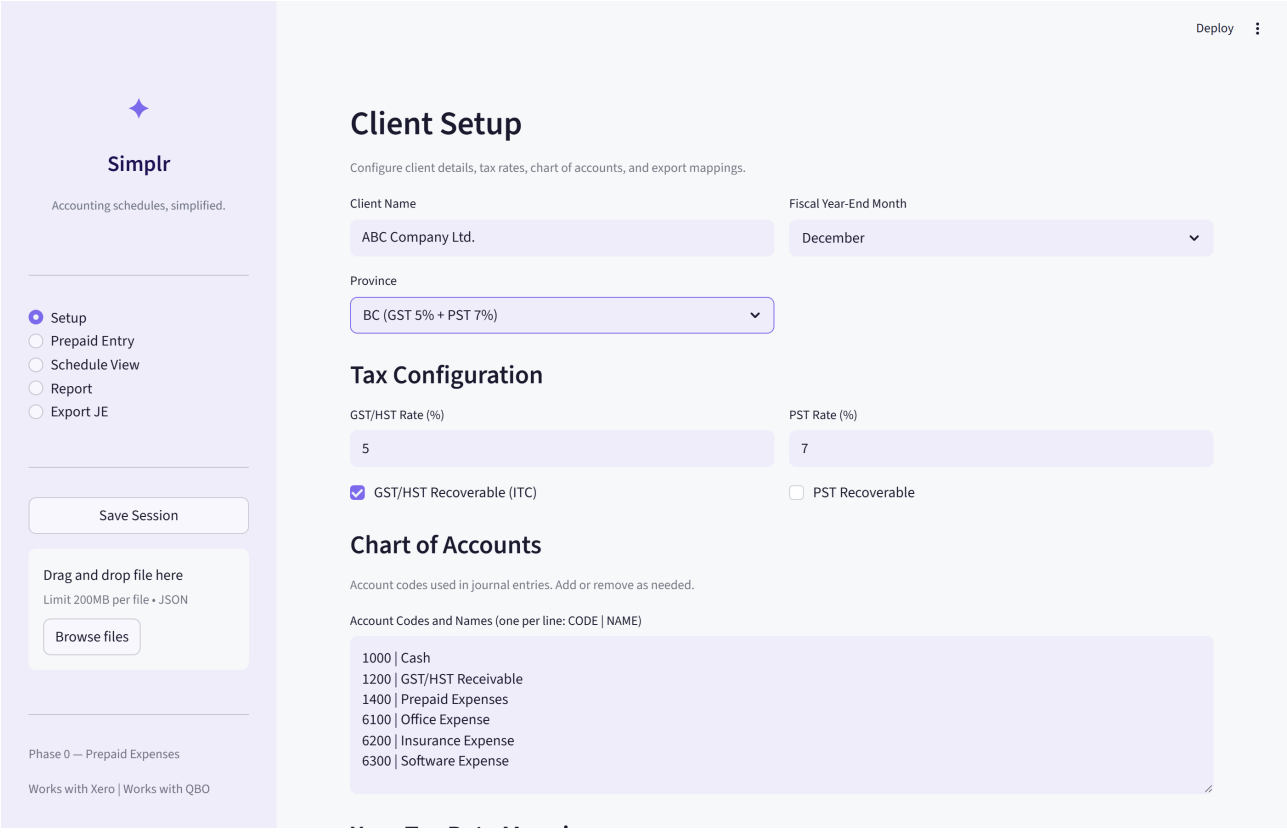


Figure 3.1 - The Setup page overview with Client Name, Province, and Fiscal Year

3.1 Client Name and Fiscal Year

Field	What to enter	Example
Client Name	The name of the client	ABC Company Ltd.
Fiscal Year-End Month	Month their fiscal year ends	December (most common)
Province	Client province (auto-fills tax rates)	BC (GST 5% + PST 7%)

How Province works: When you select a province, the GST/HST and PST rates below automatically update to that province's rates. For example: BC = GST 5% + PST 7%, Ontario = HST 13% (no separate PST), Alberta = GST 5% only (no PST).

3.2 Tax Configuration

Scroll down to the Tax Configuration section:

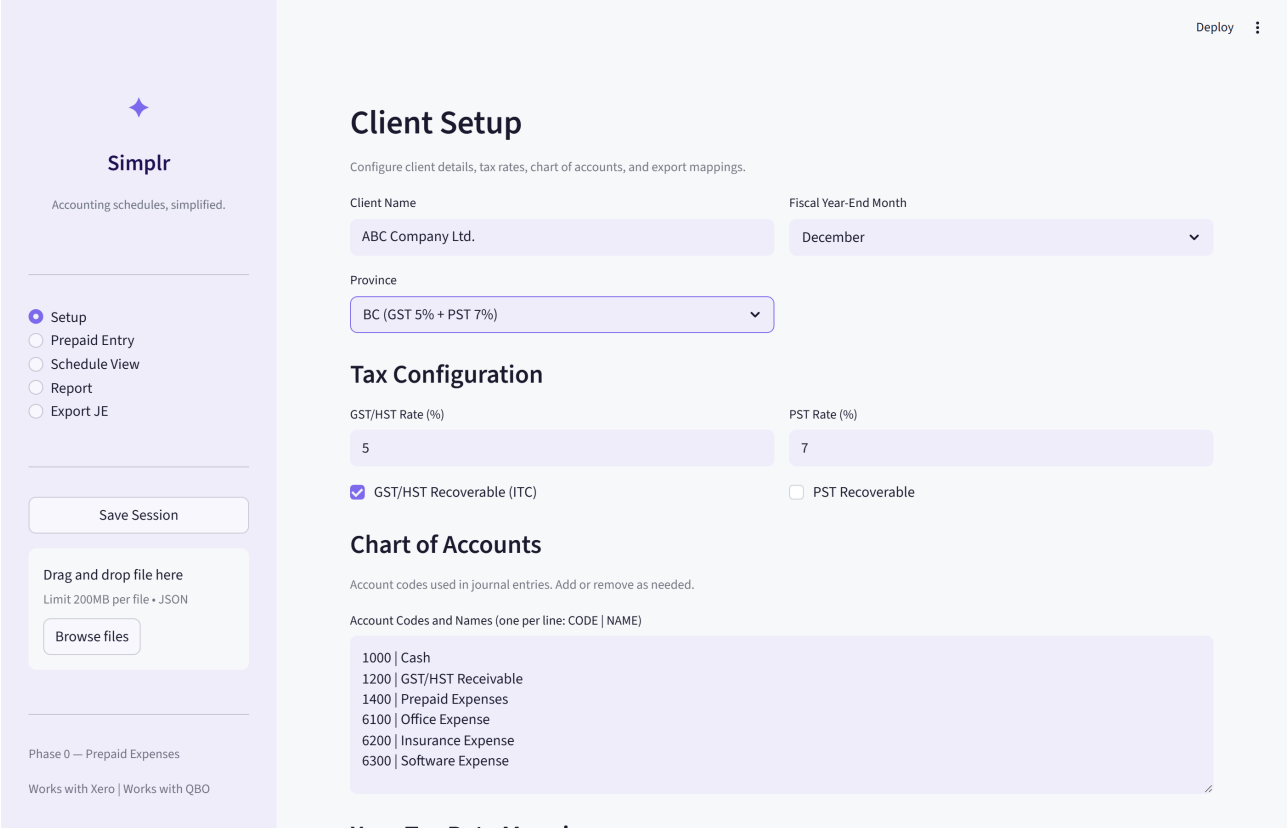


Figure 3.2 - Tax configuration: GST/HST rate, PST rate, and recoverability checkboxes

Field	What it means	Default (BC)
GST/HST Rate (%)	The GST or HST percentage	5
GST/HST Recoverable (ITC)	Can client claim GST/HST as ITC?	Checked
PST Rate (%)	The PST percentage	7
PST Recoverable	Is PST recoverable? (almost never)	Unchecked

WHY THIS MATTERS:
- GST/HST Recoverable (checked): GST becomes a separate ITC entry, NOT added to the prepaid asset
- PST Not Recoverable (unchecked): PST gets CAPITALIZED into the prepaid amount

Example: $12,000 insurance in BC:
GST 5% = $600 ITC (separate) | PST 7% = $840 (added to prepaid)
Capitalized = $12,840 | Total cash = $13,440

3.3 Chart of Accounts

This is where you enter the account codes and names that match your Xero or QBO chart of accounts. Format: One account per line, as CODE | NAME

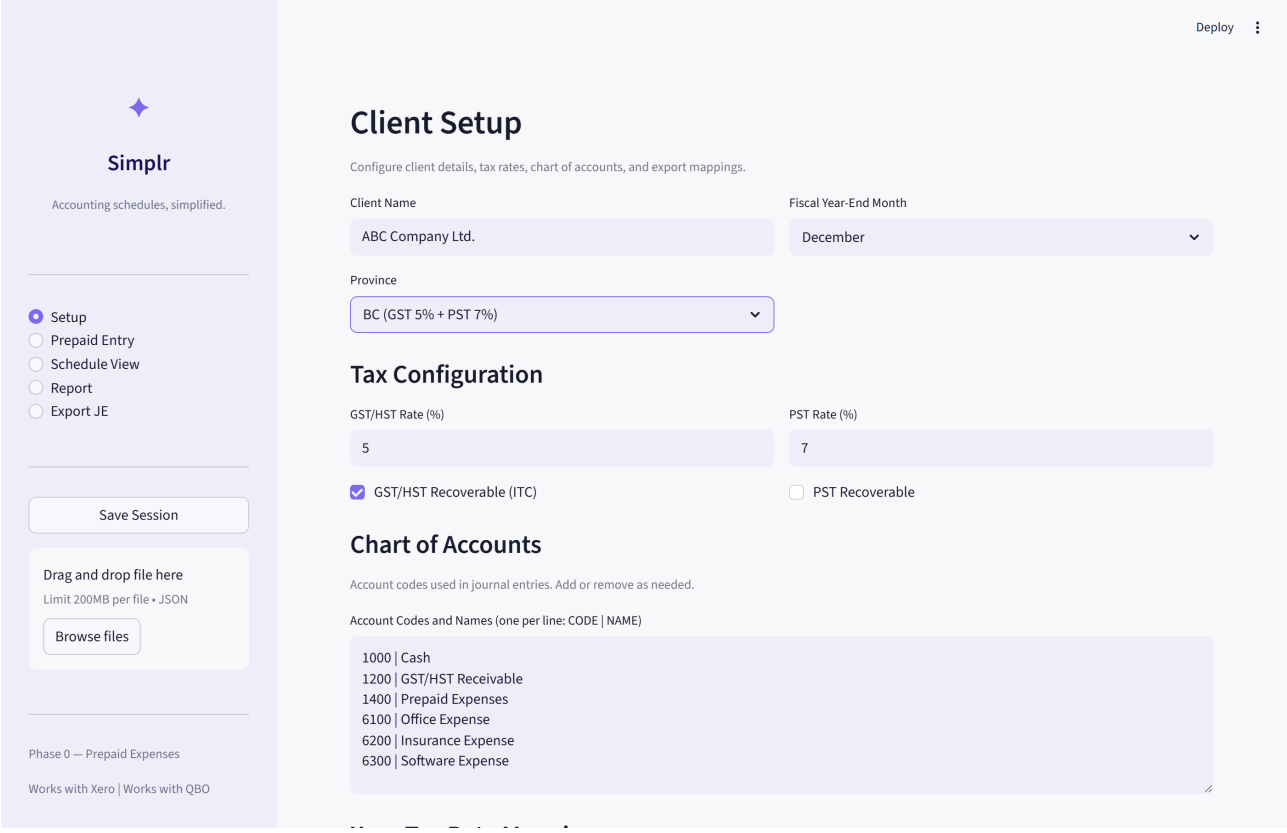


Figure 3.3 - Chart of Accounts text area: enter one account per line as CODE | NAME

```
1000 | Cash
1200 | GST/HST Receivable
1400 | Prepaid Expenses
6100 | Office Expense
6200 | Insurance Expense
6300 | Software Expense
```

To customize: Delete accounts you do not need, add new ones that match your Xero/QBO. Make sure the codes and names match EXACTLY what is in your accounting system.

3.4 Xero Tax Rate Mapping

CRITICAL FOR XERO IMPORTS: The TaxRateName must match EXACTLY (case-sensitive!) what appears in your client Xero account. 'Tax Exempt' is NOT the same as 'Tax exempt'.
If the case does not match, the Xero import will fail silently.

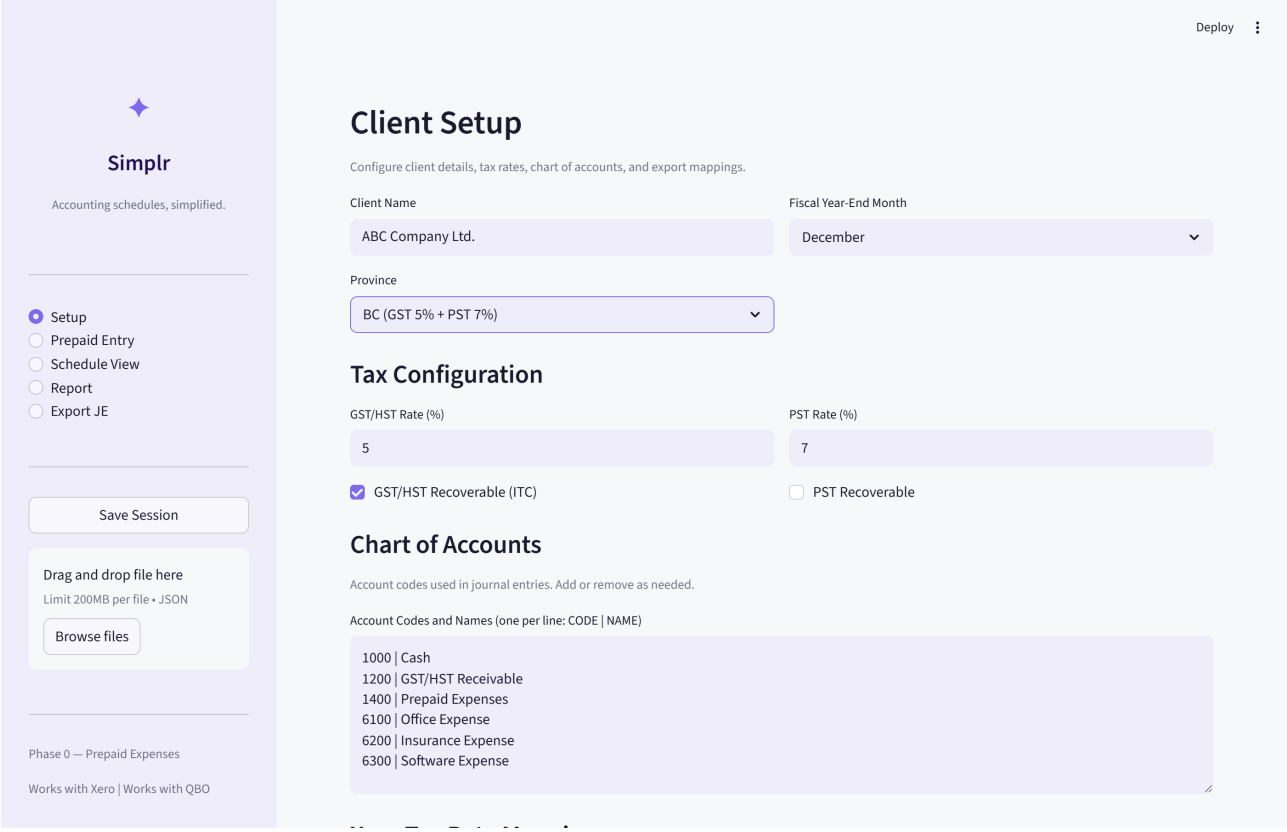


Figure 3.4 - Xero Tax Rate Names: must match exactly what is in your Xero account

To find the correct names: Log into Xero > Settings > General Settings > Tax Rates. Copy the exact names.

Default values provided:

```
Tax Exempt
GST on Expenses
HST ON EXPENSES
```

3.5 Tracking Categories (Optional)

If your client uses Tracking Categories in Xero (or Classes in QBO):

Field	What to enter	Example
Tracking Category Name	Name of the tracking category	Department
Tracking Option	The specific option/value	Administration

Leave both blank if the client does not use tracking categories.

3.6 Special Accounts

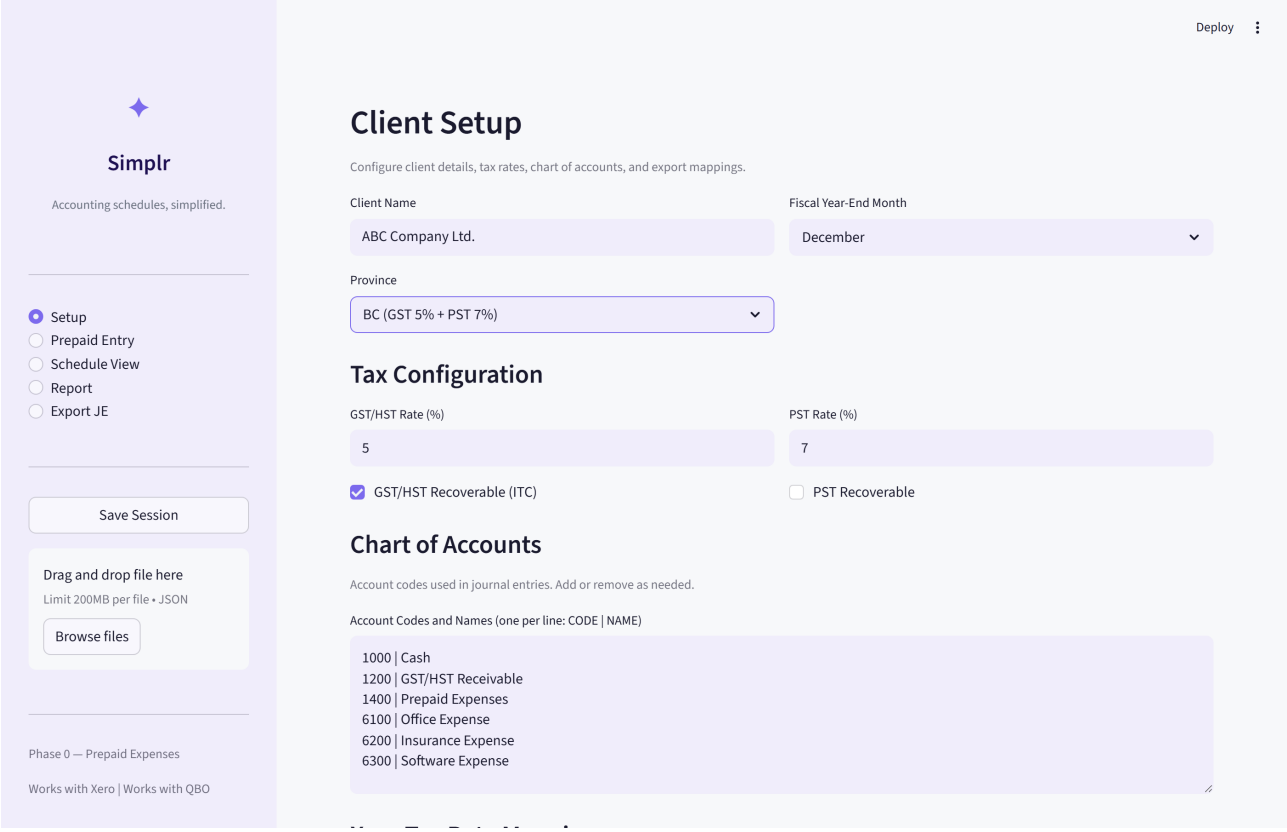


Figure 3.5 - Special Accounts: Cash/AP and GST/HST Receivable dropdowns

Field	What to select	Purpose
Cash / AP Account	Account for cash payments	Used in Setup JE (initial recording)
GST/HST Receivable	Account for GST/HST ITC	Used when GST/HST is recoverable

4. Step 2: Creating a Prepaid Contract

Click "Prepaid Entry" in the sidebar. You will see the empty contract entry form:

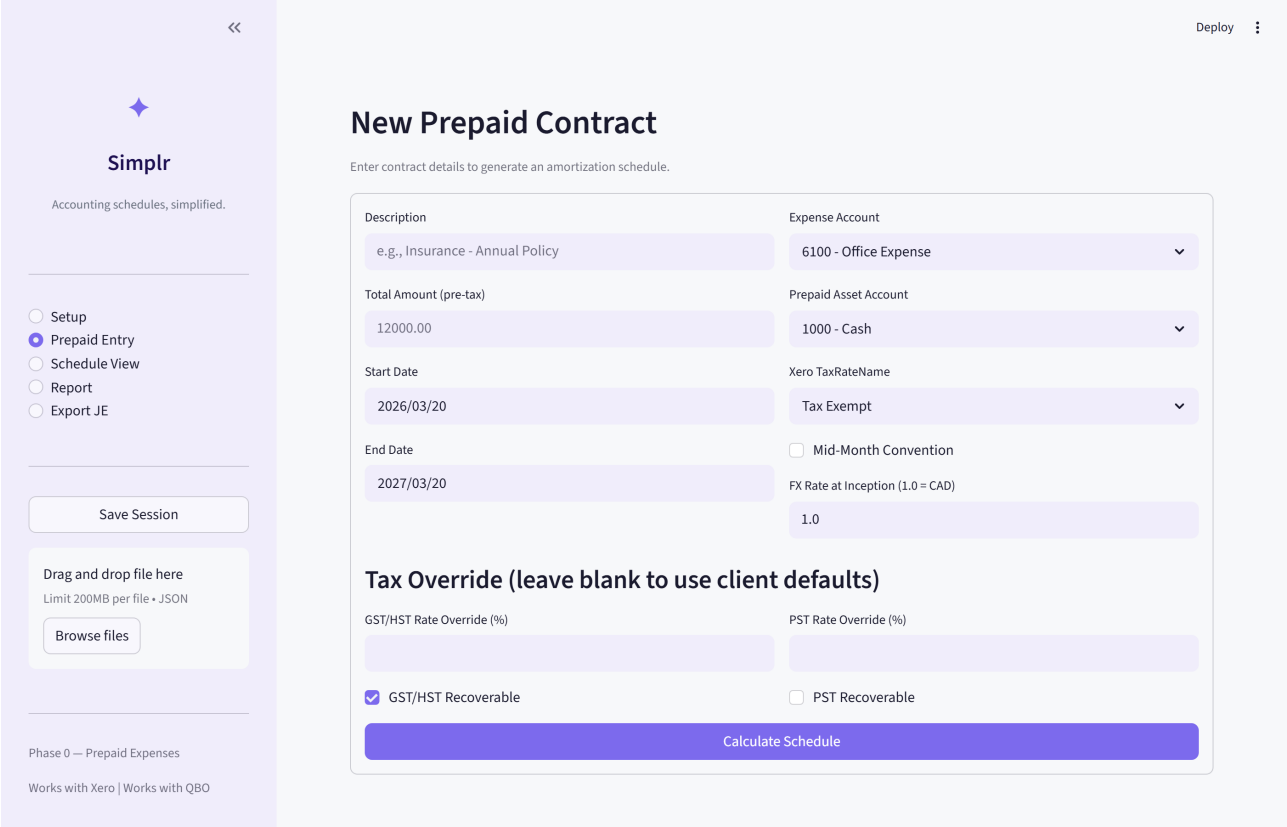


Figure 4.1 - The Prepaid Entry form (empty, ready to fill)

4.1 Fill in the Contract Details

Left column fields:

Field	What to enter	Example
Description	Clear name for this contract	Insurance - Annual Policy 2026
Total Amount (pre-tax)	Contract amount BEFORE taxes	12000.00
Start Date	When the prepaid period begins	2026/01/01
End Date	When the prepaid period ends	2026/12/31

Right column fields:

Field	What to select	Example
Expense Account	Expense account to debit monthly	6200 - Insurance Expense
Prepaid Asset Account	Balance sheet account to credit	1400 - Prepaid Expenses
Xero TaxRateName	Tax rate name for Xero export	Tax Exempt
Mid-Month Convention	Check if contract starts mid-month	Usually unchecked
FX Rate	Exchange rate (1.0 = CAD)	1.0

Here is an example with the form filled in for ABC Company insurance policy:

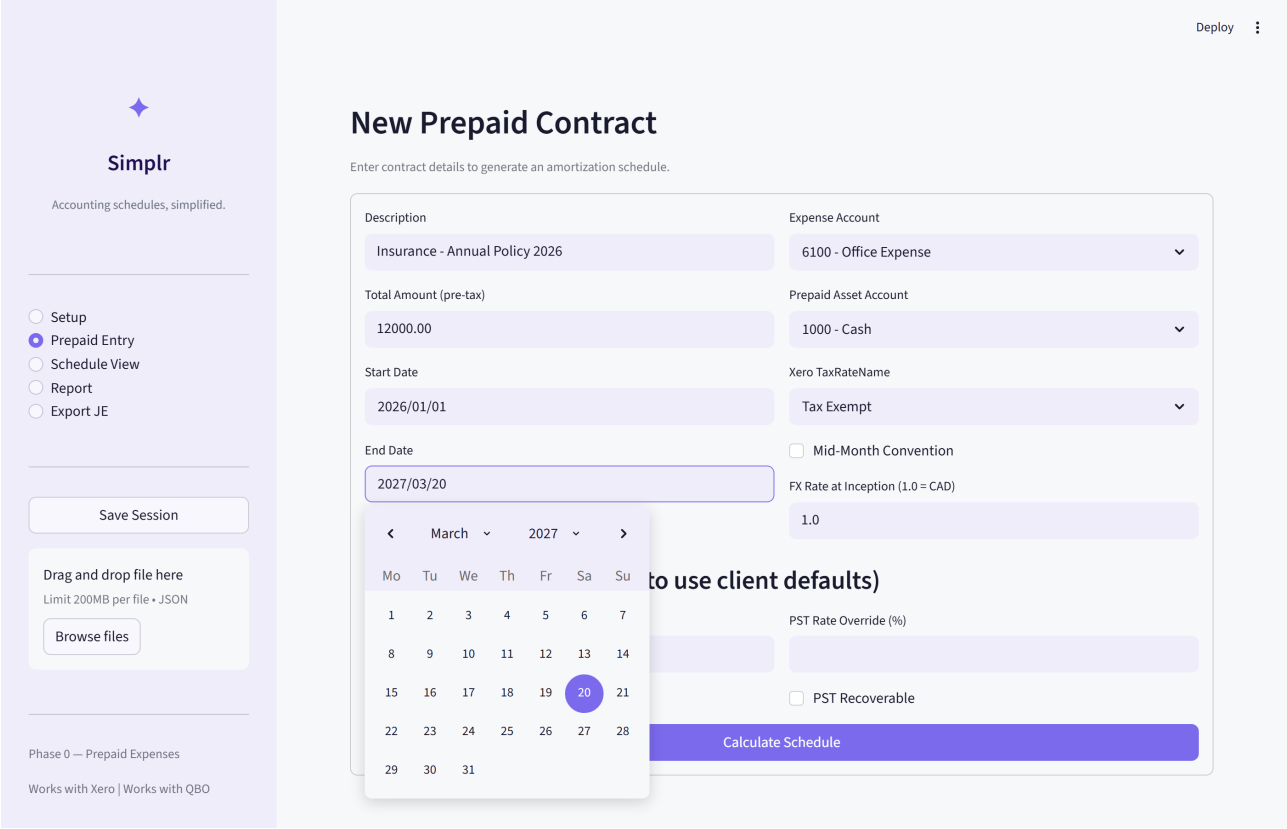


Figure 4.2 - Contract form filled with sample data: Insurance $12,000

MID-MONTH CONVENTION:
- Unchecked (default): Equal monthly amounts. $12,000 / 12 = $1,000/month
- Checked: First and last months get proportional share based on actual days.
Use this when the contract starts/ends mid-month and you need exact allocation.

4.2 Tax Override (Optional)

If this specific contract has different tax treatment than the client defaults, you can override here. Leave the override fields blank to use the client default rates from the Setup page.

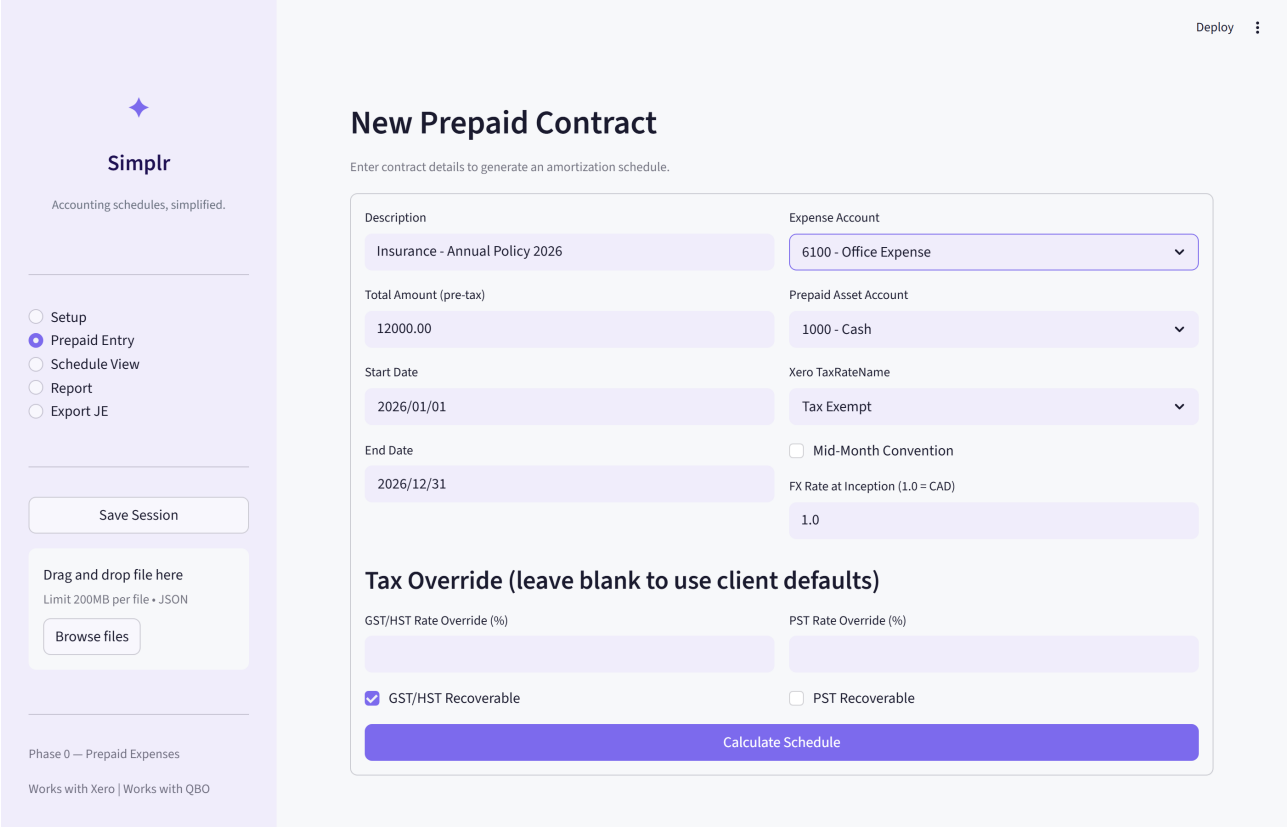


Figure 4.3 - Tax Override section: leave blank to use client defaults

4.3 Calculate and Confirm

Click the purple "Calculate Schedule" button at the bottom. If successful, you will see a green confirmation message.

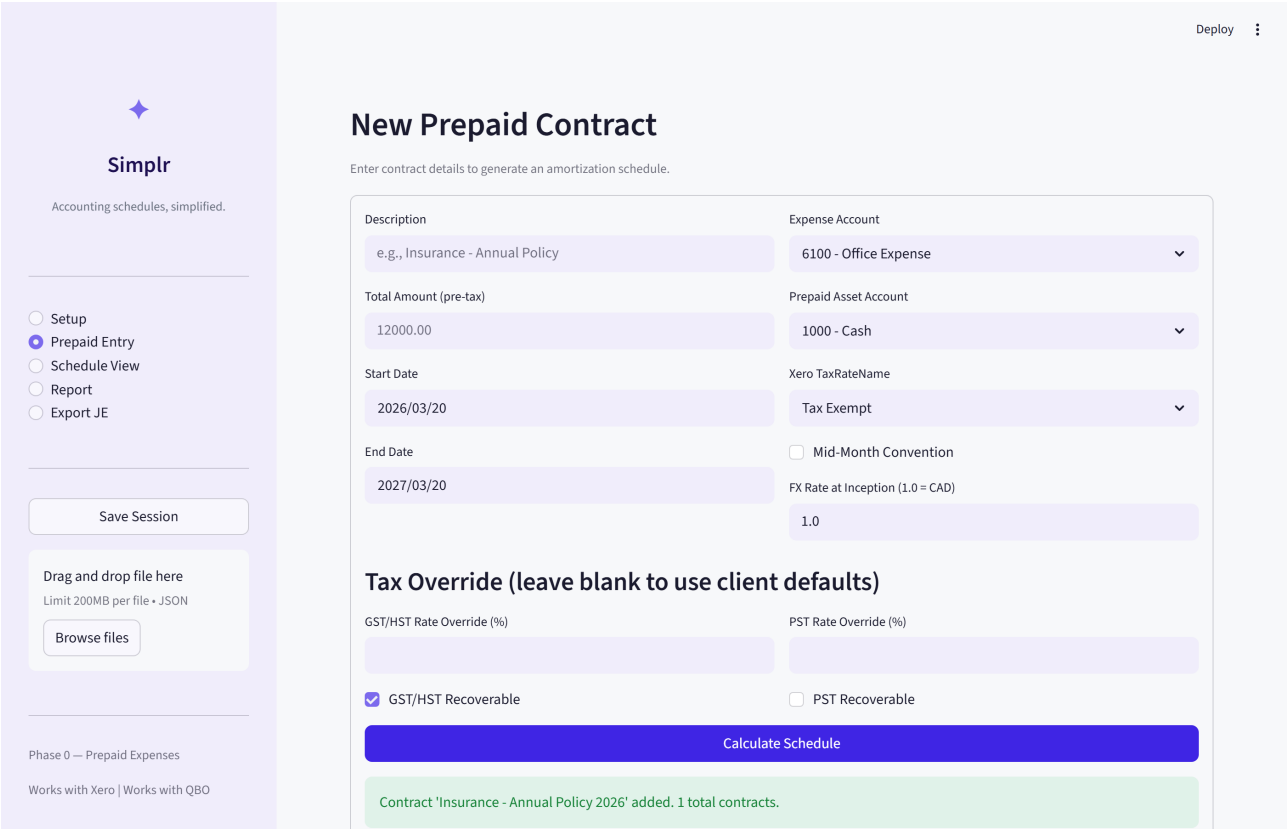


Figure 4.4 - Success! Contract calculated and added. Green message at bottom confirms it.

- You can add multiple contracts by filling in the form again and clicking Calculate

- To remove a contract, click the "Remove" button next to it in the list below the form

5. Step 3: Viewing the Amortization Schedule

Click "Schedule View" in the sidebar.

This page shows the full amortization schedule for each contract, with summary metrics at the top and a detailed month-by-month breakdown.

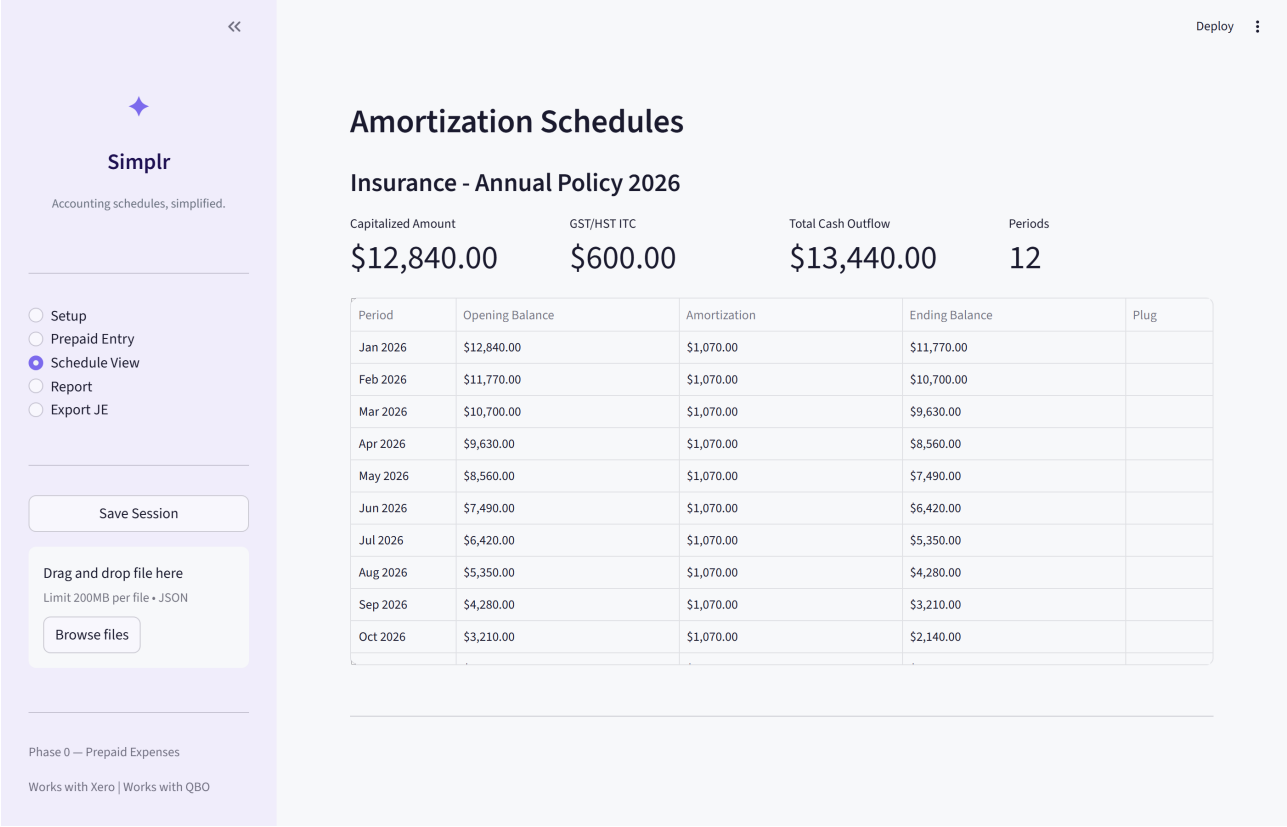


Figure 5.1 - Schedule View showing the Insurance contract with all 12 months

5.1 Summary Metrics

At the top of each contract schedule, you see four key metrics:

Metric	What it shows	Example Value
Capitalized Amount	Amount on the balance sheet (after PST if applicable)	$12,840.00
GST/HST ITC	Separate ITC amount (if GST is recoverable)	$600.00
Total Cash Outflow	Total paid (capitalized + ITC)	$13,440.00
Periods	Number of months in the schedule	12

5.2 Amortization Table

The table below the metrics shows the month-by-month amortization breakdown:

Column	What it shows
Period	The month (e.g., Jan 2026, Feb 2026, etc.)
Opening Balance	Balance at start of that month
Amortization	Amount expensed that month
Ending Balance	Balance after amortization
Plug	Yes on the last month (absorbs rounding difference)

KEY THINGS TO VERIFY:

- First month Opening Balance = the Capitalized Amount ($12,840.00)

- Last month Ending Balance = $0.00 (always, exactly)

- Sum of all Amortization amounts = Capitalized Amount (exactly)

6. Step 4: Generating the Roll-Forward Report

Click "Report" in the sidebar. This generates a working paper roll-forward report in the format CPAs expect: Opening Balance + Additions - Amortization = Ending Balance.

6.1 Set the Period

Choose the report period using the date fields at the top:

Field	What to enter	Example
Period Start	First day of the report period	2026/01/01
Period End	Last day of the report period	2026/12/31

6.2 Generate the Report

Click the purple "Generate Report" button. Here is the result:

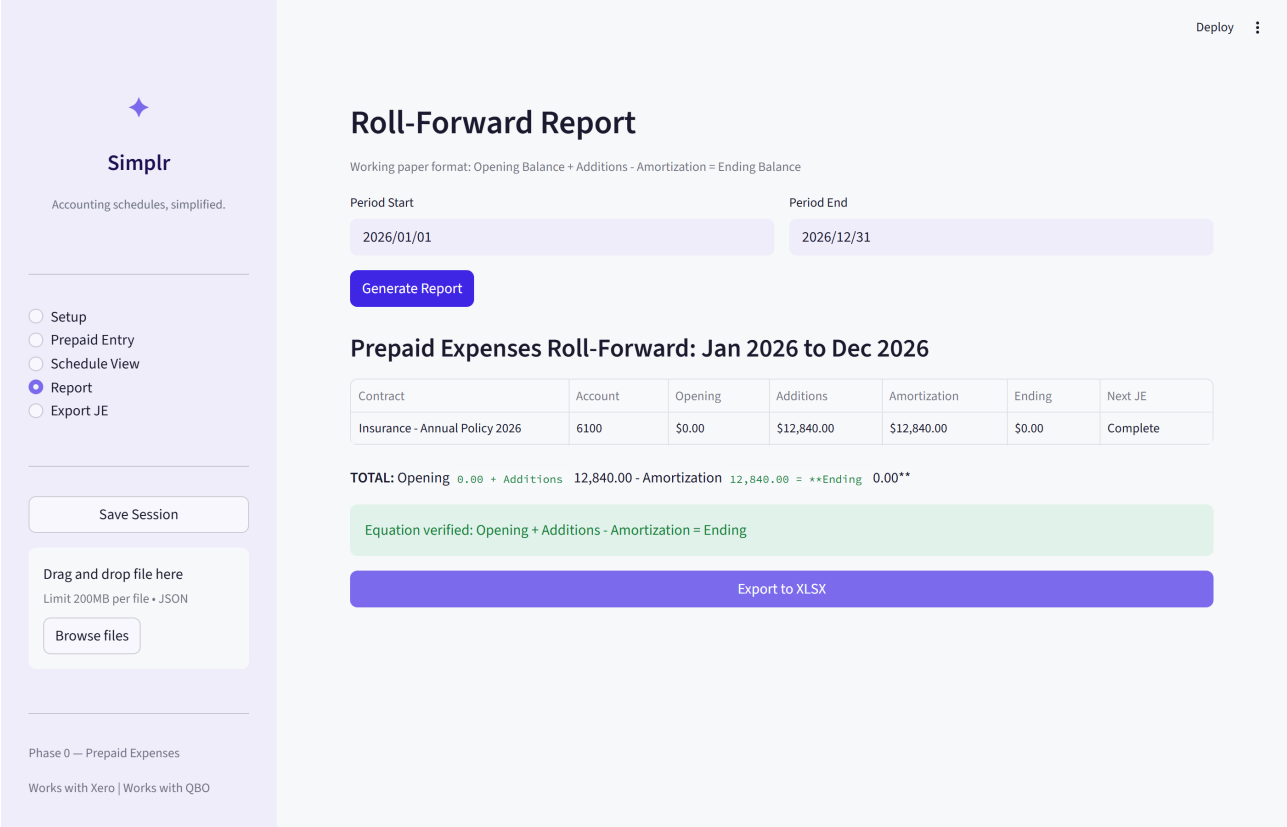


Figure 6.1 - Roll-Forward Report for Jan-Dec 2026 showing full-year amortization

6.3 Report Columns Explained

Column	Meaning
Contract	Contract description
Account	Expense account code
Opening	Balance at start of period
Additions	New contracts added during period
Amortization	Total amortized during period
Ending	Balance at end of period
Next JE	Next month amortization amount (or Complete)

The system automatically verifies that Opening + Additions - Amortization = Ending. A green checkmark confirms the equation balances.

6.4 Export to XLSX

Click the purple "Export to XLSX" button to download an Excel file with report metadata, per-contract breakdown, totals row, and professional formatting.

7. Step 5: Exporting Journal Entries (CSV)

Click "Export JE" in the sidebar. This is the final step - generating the CSV file to import into Xero or QBO.

7.1 Select Export Parameters

At the top of the page, configure the export:

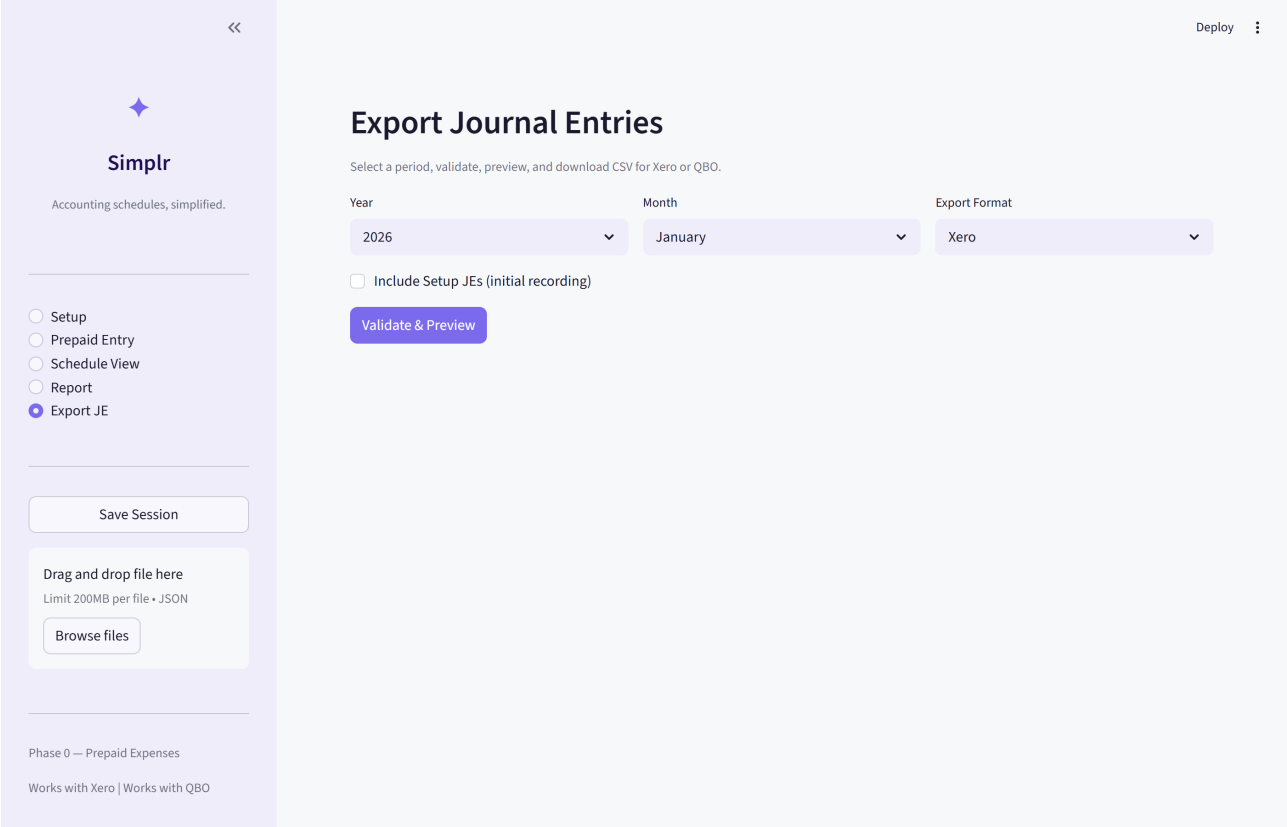


Figure 7.1 - Export JE page: select Year, Month, Format (Xero/QBO)

Field	What to select	Notes
Year	Year of the journal entries	e.g., 2026
Month	Specific month to export	January, February, etc.
Export Format	Target system	Xero or QBO
Include Setup JEs	Include initial recording?	Only for the contract start month

7.2 Validate & Preview

Click the purple "Validate & Preview" button. The system checks:

- Are all journal entries balanced (debits = credits)?
- Do all account codes exist in your Chart of Accounts?
- Does the TaxRateName match your configured mappings? (case-sensitive!)
- Is the period open?
- Was this period already exported? (warning if yes)

Here is the result after successful validation:

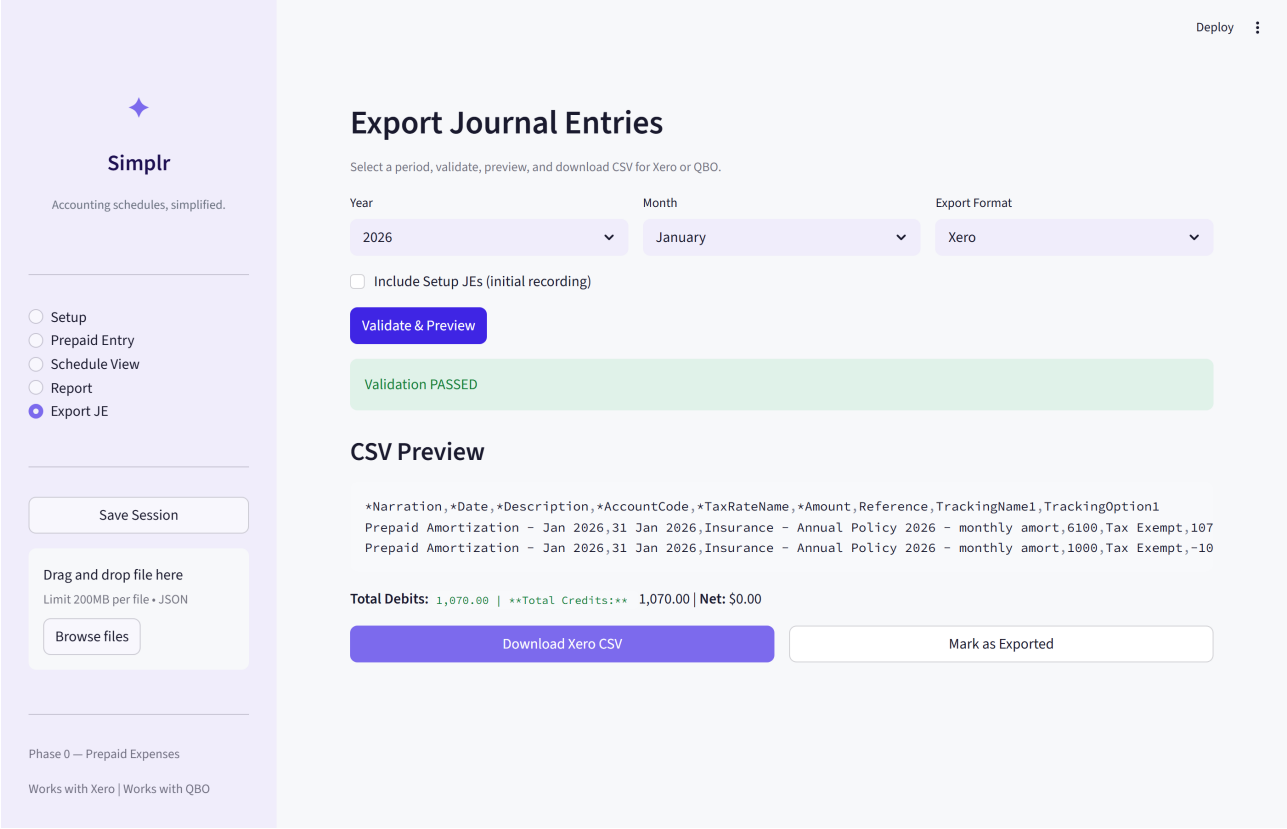


Figure 7.2 - Validation PASSED with CSV Preview showing the Xero journal entry

VALIDATION PASSED = green message. You can download the CSV.
VALIDATION FAILED = red error messages. Fix issues in Setup, then try again.

7.3 Understanding the CSV Preview

The CSV content is shown in a preview box. Review carefully before downloading.

For Xero CSV, verify:

- Date format is DD MMM YYYY (e.g., 31 Jan 2026) - NEVER MM/DD/YYYY
- Amounts: positive = debit, negative = credit
- TaxRateName matches exactly what is in your Xero

For QBO CSV, verify:

- Date format is MM/DD/YYYY (e.g., 01/31/2026)
- Debit and Credit are in separate columns
- Account names (not codes) match your QBO

7.4 Download and Import into Xero

1. Click "Download Xero CSV" (or "Download QBO CSV")
2. Click "Mark as Exported" to record this period was exported
3. Open Xero > Accounting > Manual Journals > Import
4. Upload the CSV file

5. Xero shows a preview - verify it looks correct
6. Click Import (journals arrive as Draft - review and post)

8. Saving and Loading Your Work

IMPORTANT: Simplr Phase 0 does not have a database. If you close the browser, your data is lost. ALWAYS use Save/Load to preserve your work.

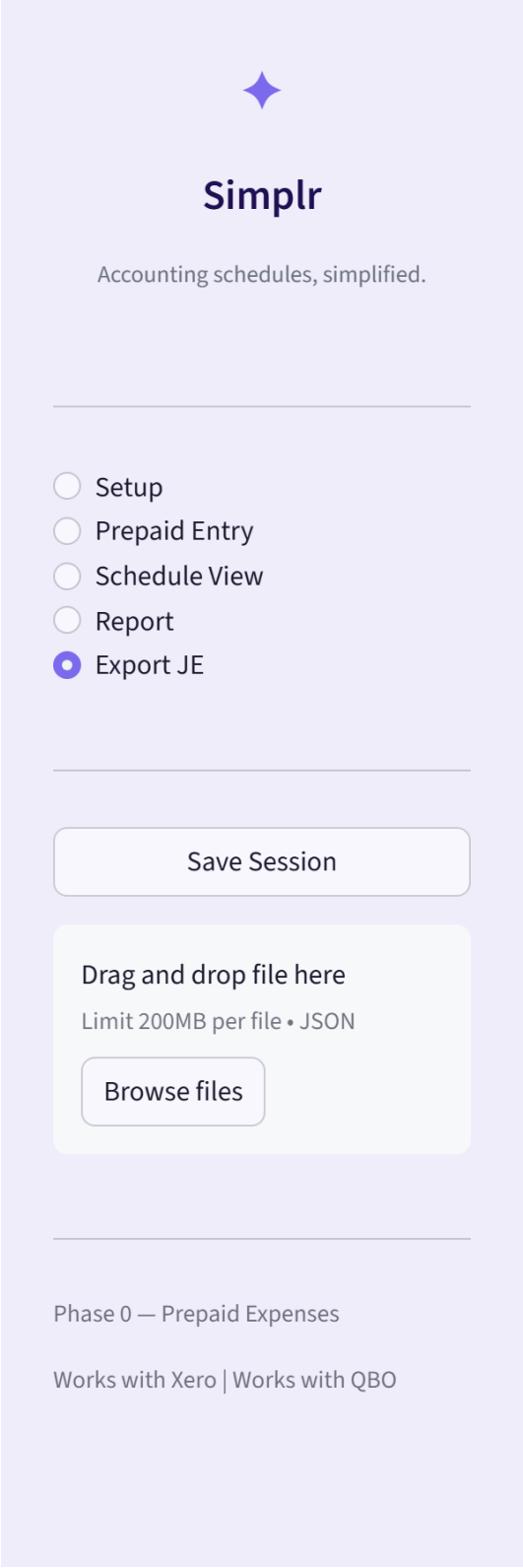


Figure 8.1 - Save and Load controls in the sidebar

Saving Your Session

1. Look at the sidebar (left side)
2. Click the "Save Session" button
3. A JSON file downloads (e.g., simplr_session_2026-03-20.json)
4. Keep this file safe - it contains all your client config and contracts

Loading a Previous Session

1. Look at the sidebar (left side)
2. In the "Drag and drop file here" area:
   - Drag your saved JSON file onto it, OR
   - Click "Browse files" and select the JSON file
3. The system loads all your data and you can continue where you left off

> **TIP: Save your session after every significant change. Rename files meaningfully (e.g., simplr_ABC_Company_March2026.json) to stay organized.**

9. Example: Complete Walkthrough

This section walks through a real example from start to finish: ABC Company Ltd. in BC, with a $12,000 annual insurance policy.

Step 1: Setup

1. Click "Setup" in sidebar
2. Enter Client Name: ABC Company Ltd.
3. Select Province: BC (GST 5% + PST 7%)
4. Fiscal Year-End Month: December
5. Tax config auto-fills: GST 5% recoverable, PST 7% non-recoverable
6. Verify Chart of Accounts matches your Xero

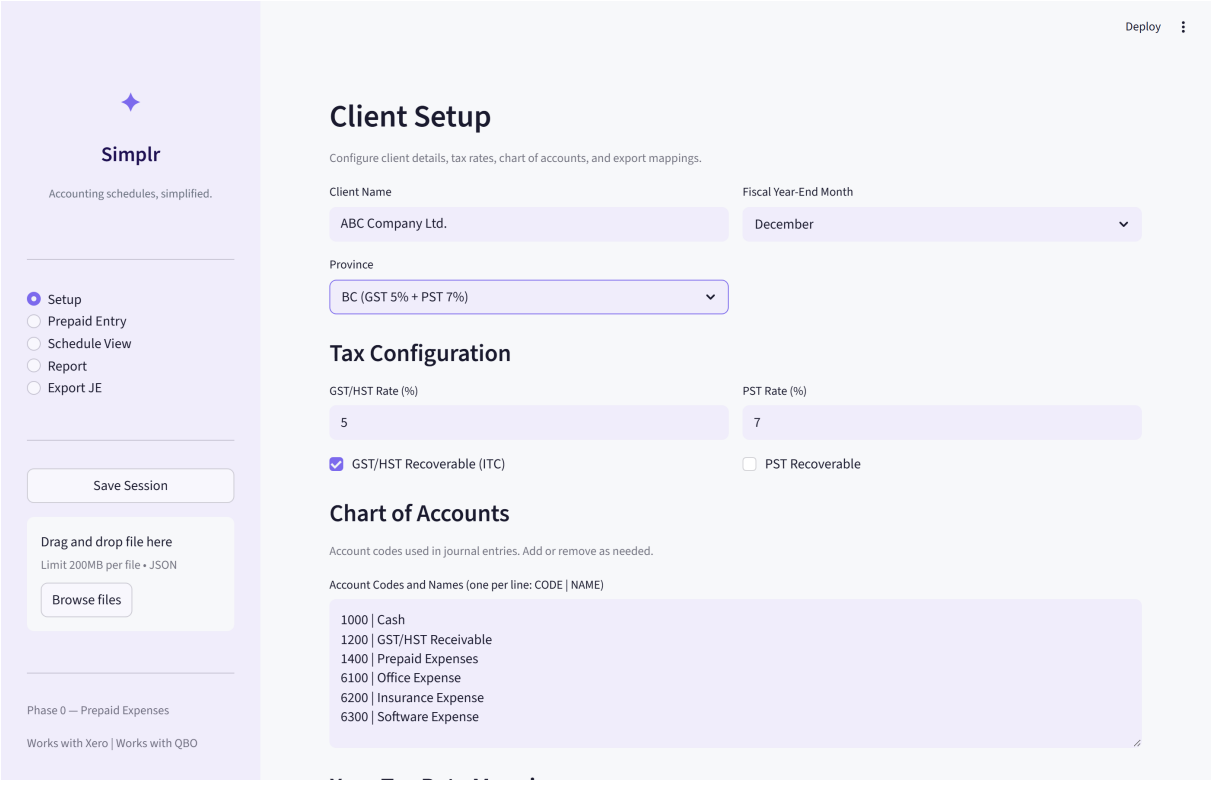


Figure 9.1 - Setup page with ABC Company Ltd. configured

Step 2: Create Contract

1. Click "Prepaid Entry" in sidebar
2. Description: Insurance - Annual Policy 2026
3. Total Amount: 12000.00
4. Start Date: 2026/01/01 | End Date: 2026/12/31
5. Expense Account: 6200 - Insurance Expense
6. Prepaid Asset Account: 1400 - Prepaid Expenses
7. Xero TaxRateName: Tax Exempt
8. Click "Calculate Schedule"

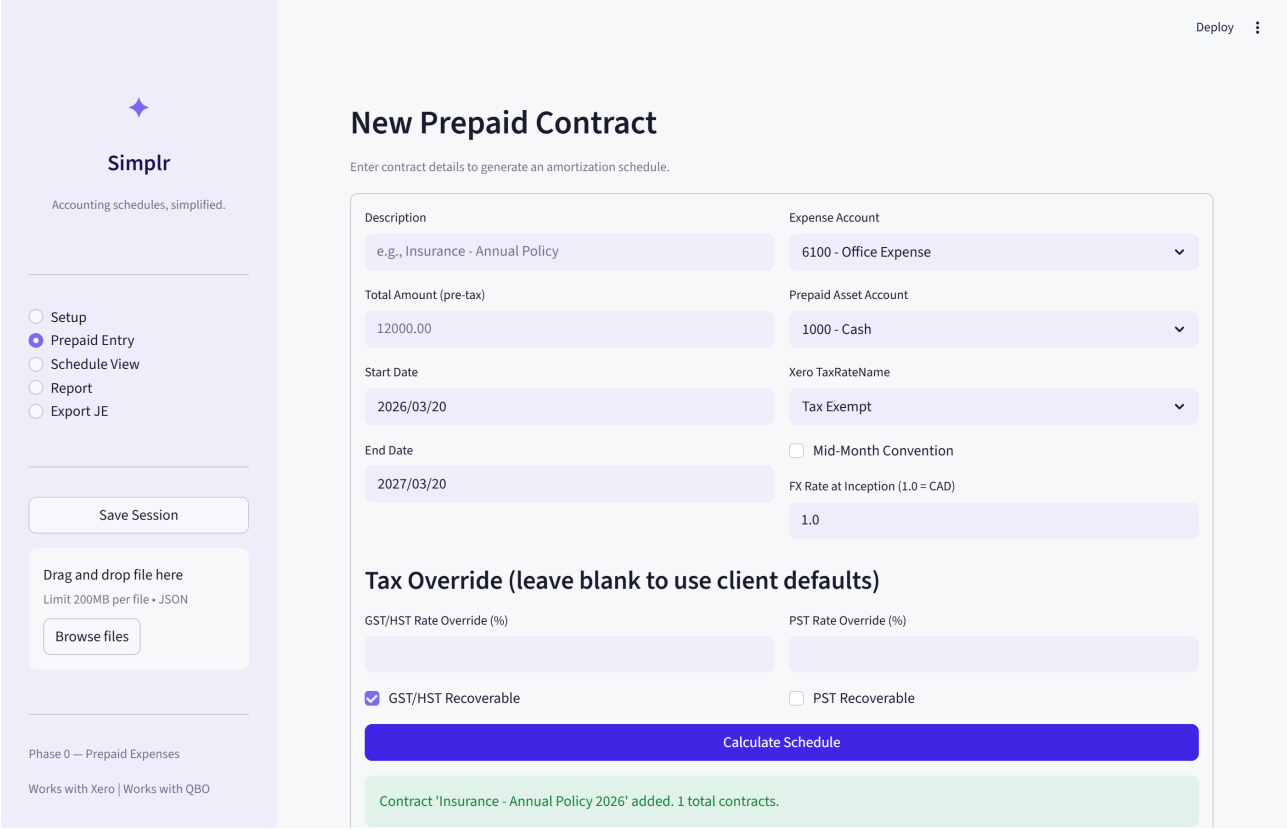
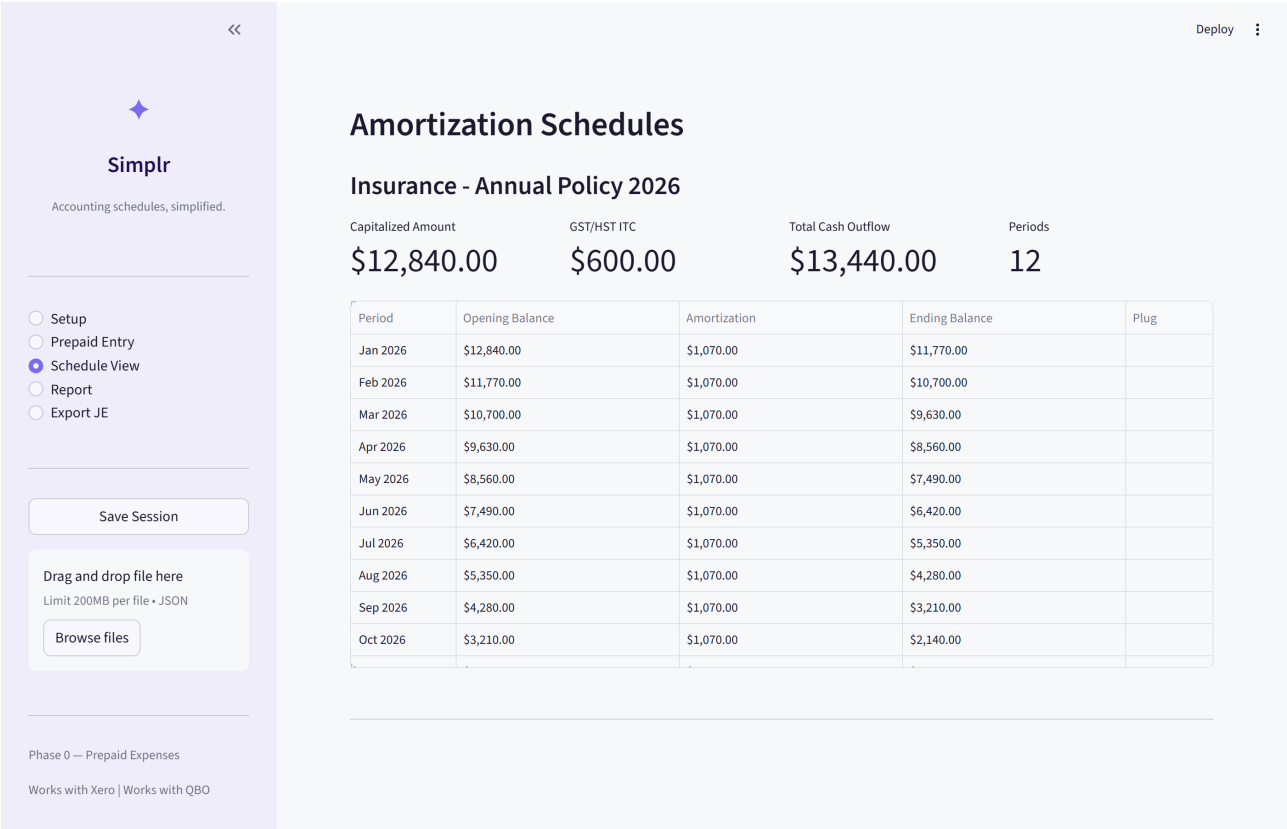


Figure 9.2 - Contract calculated successfully (green message at bottom)

Step 3: Verify Schedule

Click "Schedule View". You should see:



Period	Opening Balance	Amortization	Ending Balance	Plug
Jan 2026	$12,840.00	$1,070.00	$11,770.00	
Feb 2026	$11,770.00	$1,070.00	$10,700.00	
Mar 2026	$10,700.00	$1,070.00	$9,630.00	
Apr 2026	$9,630.00	$1,070.00	$8,560.00	
May 2026	$8,560.00	$1,070.00	$7,490.00	
Jun 2026	$7,490.00	$1,070.00	$6,420.00	
Jul 2026	$6,420.00	$1,070.00	$5,350.00	
Aug 2026	$5,350.00	$1,070.00	$4,280.00	
Sep 2026	$4,280.00	$1,070.00	$3,210.00	
Oct 2026	$3,210.00	$1,070.00	$2,140.00	

Figure 9.3 - Amortization schedule with $1,070/month for 12 months

Metric	Expected Value	Why
Capitalized Amount	$12,840.00	$12,000 + 7% PST ($840)
GST/HST ITC	$600.00	5% GST on $12,000
Total Cash Outflow	$13,440.00	$12,840 + $600
Monthly Amortization	$1,070.00	$12,840 / 12 months
Periods	12	Jan to Dec 2026
Final Ending Balance	$0.00	Always zero

Step 4: Generate Report

1. Click "Report" in sidebar
2. Period Start: 2026/01/01 | Period End: 2026/12/31
3. Click "Generate Report"

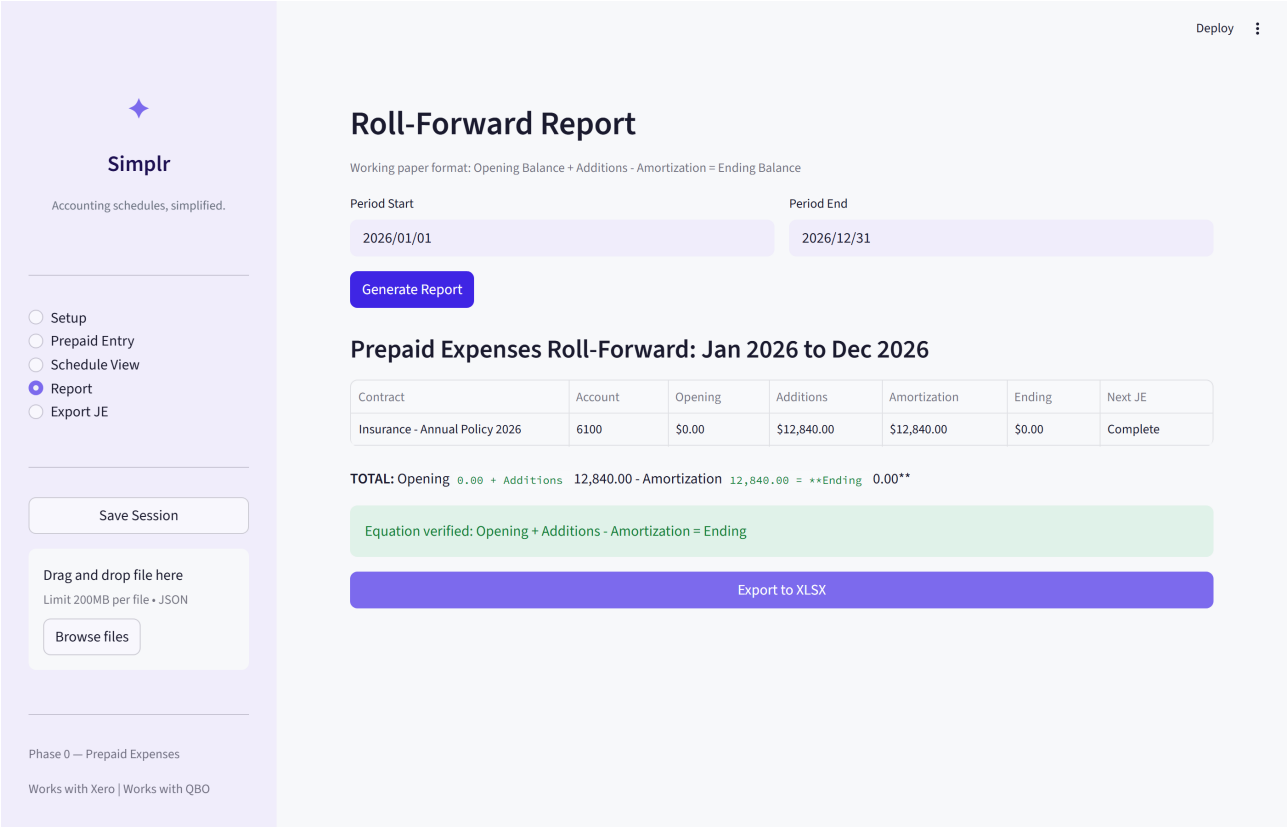


Figure 9.4 - Roll-Forward Report: $12,840 Additions, $12,840 Amortization, $0 Ending

Step 5: Export January to Xero

1. Click "Export JE" | Year: 2026 | Month: January | Format: Xero
2. Click "Validate & Preview"
3. Review the CSV preview

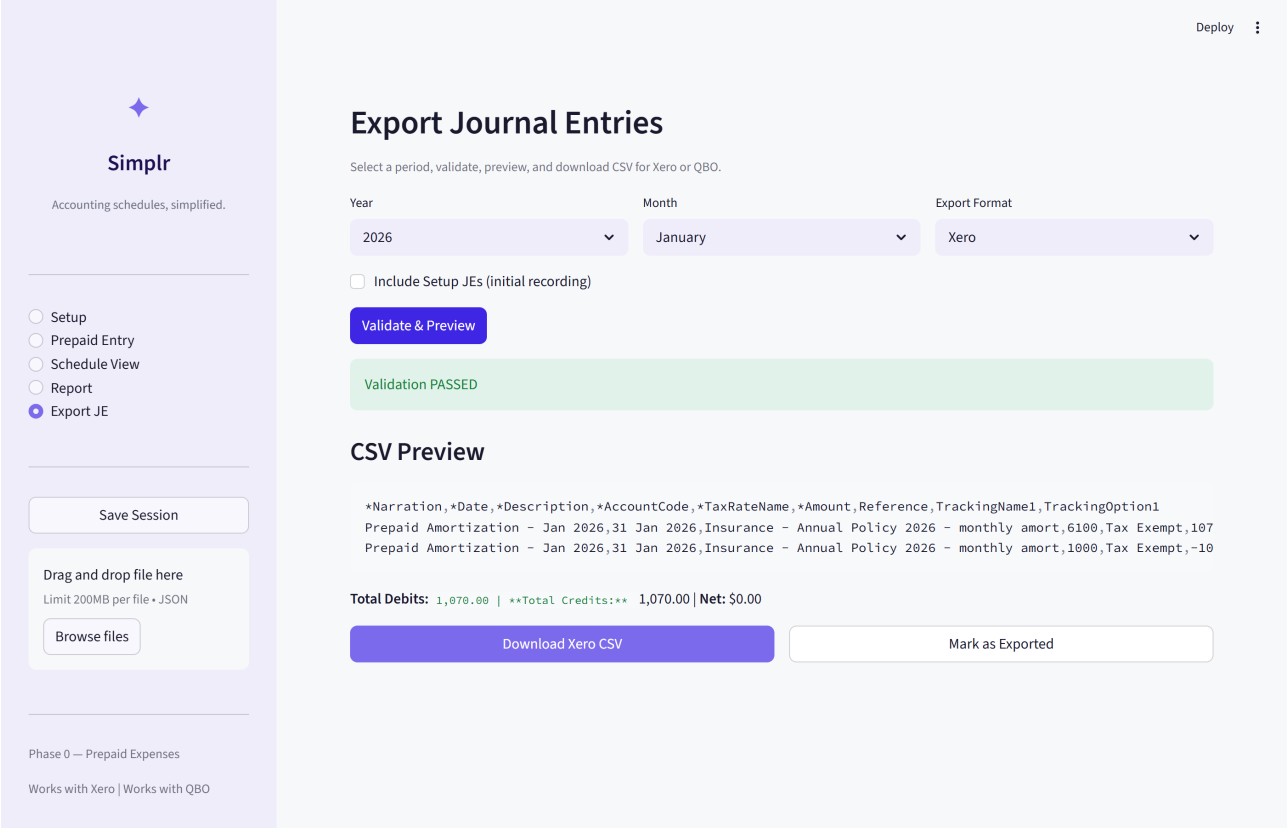


Figure 9.5 - Validation PASSED: CSV ready to download for Xero import

4. Click "Download Xero CSV"
5. Click "Mark as Exported"
6. Import into Xero > Accounting > Manual Journals > Import

Step 6: Export February

1. Change Month to February
2. Validate, Preview, Download, Import

Repeat for each subsequent month (March, April, etc.).

Step 7: Save Your Work

Click "Save Session" in the sidebar. Keep the file safe.

10. Troubleshooting & FAQ

Validation FAILED - INVALID_TAX_RATE

The TaxRateName does not match what is in Xero. Go to Setup > Xero Tax Rate Mapping and make sure the names are EXACTLY the same (case-sensitive). Check your Xero account: Settings > Tax Rates.

Validation FAILED - INVALID_ACCOUNT

An account code in the journal entry does not exist in your Chart of Accounts. Go to Setup > Chart of Accounts and add the missing account.

No journal entries found for this period

The selected month does not have any entries. Check that you have created a contract and that the selected month falls within the contract start/end dates.

This period was previously exported

This is a WARNING, not an error. It means you already exported this month. If you import again into Xero, you will create DUPLICATE entries.

Data disappeared after refreshing

Simplr Phase 0 stores data in the browser session only. Always use Save Session to keep your work. Use Load Session (drag JSON file) to restore it.

How do I add more contracts?

Go to Prepaid Entry and fill in the form again. Each Calculate Schedule click adds a new contract. All contracts appear together in Schedule View and Reports.

Can I edit a contract?

In Phase 0, you cannot edit directly. Remove the contract (click Remove button) and re-create it with the correct values.

What is the Plug column?

The last month absorbs any rounding difference (the plug). This ensures the ending balance is always exactly $0.00, even when amounts do not divide evenly.

The amounts do not look right

Check: (1) Did you enter the PRE-TAX amount? (2) Is the province set correctly? (3) Is PST set to non-recoverable? BC PST gets added to the prepaid amount.

*

Simplr

Accounting schedules, simplified.

Need help? Contact your system administrator.

Phase 0 | Prepaid Expenses Module | Version 0.1.0